

qualm of mine is that the base 128 GB variant uses slower UFS 3.1 storage while the 256 GB variant has UFS 4.0 speeds. So, if you're buying the base models, note that you may not get the same speeds as we did in our storage benchmarks.

Speaking of benchmarks, let's dive into that. I compared the OnePlus 12R to similarly-priced phones such as the HONOR 90, Vivo X29 Pro, and iQOO Neo 7 Pro across a slew of synthetic benchmark tests. In AnTuTu, the 12R came out of the top but barely. The iQOO Neo 7 Pro with the Snapdragon 8+ Gen 1 was only behind by a slight margin (and it costs only ₹34K). In fact, the OnePlus 12R was behind the iQOO Neo 7 Pro in every other CPU benchmark we ran. But it does overtake the HONOR and Vivo significantly in the GeekBench Multi-Core Test.

In GPU benchmarks, the scores were pretty decent across the board in 3D Mark and GFXBench, however, the numbers do indicate there's some level of throttling going on here. To confirm this, I ran the CPU Throttling Test for 15 minutes and the phone did throttle to 79 per cent of its peak performance. But when I ran the test for 30 minutes, it throttled further to 60 per cent of its peak performance. Either way, in real world usage, I didn't really feel the implications of this too much other than intensive gaming (and I'm talking 30 minutes of Genshin Impact).

Performance was smooth in real-world tasks, multi-tasking was a breeze and the animations look great. The phone also manages to hold its own when playing games such as BGMI and Call of Duty: Mobile.

As for the software, the OnePlus 12R runs OxygenOS 14 on top of Android 14. OnePlus has promised four years of OS updates and five years of security upgrades which feels solid for the price. The bloatware is under control too. There are no ads and very few pre-installed third-party applications. The UI looks clean, has tons of customisations, and no surprises, it is similar to a certain colourful OS.

CAMERAS

So far, the only upgrade on the OnePlus 12R that has felt generational rather than incremental is the display brightness and the introduction of LTPO technology in the R series. The cameras, sadly, aren't even an incremental upgrade. In fact, the OnePlus 12R uses the same 50 MP Sony IMX890 primary camera as the 11R and the configuration of the other lenses is also the same. You get an 8 MP ultrawide lens (with a narrower FOV than the one of the 11R) and a 2 MP macro. It blows my mind why a ₹40K smartphone still has a token 2 MP camera when phones around the ₹25K mark are now including telephoto lenses!

Rants aside, the primary camera of the OnePlus 12R is actually pretty good for the price. The Sony IMX890 has been used in the Nord series, the R series and the flagship series of OnePlus phones, so the company clearly knows its way around this sensor. Pictures in daylight look super crisp, the dynamic range is well-controlled, and colours look closer to natural than on previous OnePlus phones. I briefly faced an issue where low light images were extremely soft and fuzzy but OnePlus has issued an update that has alleviated this issue in most instances.

Portrait photos have good edge detection, and although human subjects' skin tone still doesn't look ultra-realistic, it is closer to that than it has ever been. Ultrawide photos are decent in daylight, but the edges miss out on detail and low light shots are mediocre.

The 16 MP selfie shooter is just... fine. It has the capability of clicking some flattering images but the skin tone is off once again and it handles tricky lighting poorly with haloing and blooming issues.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life has seen a pretty significant improvement on the OnePlus 12R. The company has increased the battery capacity to 5,500 mAh which translates to significantly longer screen-time. In our 4K video loop test where we play a 4K video in a loop on VLC from 100-0

per cent, the phone lasted north of 16 hours, which is fantastic.

You will easily get 6-8 hours of screen-on time with the OnePlus 12R unless you're playing games pretty much constantly. The charging speeds are also impressive. You get 100 W SUPERVOOC charging which takes the phone from 0-100 percent in just 29 minutes, according to our tests. However, OnePlus has skipped out on wireless charging, yet again.

VERDICT

If you're on the lookout for a potent all-rounder priced at ₹40,000, the OnePlus 12R emerges as a compelling option. Boasting a plethora of premium features typically found in flagship devices, such as a sturdy aluminium frame, an LTPO 4.0 AMOLED display with Dolby Vision support, and lightning-fast 100W SUPERVOOC charging, it undoubtedly delivers on multiple fronts. This device epitomizes versatility.

However, it's important to consider whether it's truly worth the upgrade if you already own a OnePlus 11R or an iQOO Neo 7 Pro. For those with the former, the enhancements offered by the OnePlus 12R might not justify the additional expenditure of ₹40,000. On the other hand, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro stands out for its superior speed. Nevertheless, for individuals in search of a new ₹40,000 phone who haven't upgraded in a while, the OnePlus 12R emerges as one of the top contenders and an easy recommendation.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 | GPU: Adreno 740 | RAM: 8/16 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 128 GB UFS3.1/256 GB UFS 4.0 | Operating System: OxygenOS 14 based on Android 14 | Display: 6.78" LTPO 4.0 AMOLED | Display resolution: 2780 x 1264 pixels | Display refresh rate: 1-120 Hz dynamic | Battery: 5,500 mAh | Charging: 100 W SUPERVOOC | Cameras (rear): 50 MP + 8 MP + 2 MP | Front camera: 16 MP | Weight: 207 g

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